

“Open source technology is a must in the world of storage”

Barun Lala,
director, storage, HP India

IDC has forecast a 46 per cent compound annual growth rate for all-Flash arrays over the next five years. These arrays provide applications with predictable high performance, while using up less physical space. Keeping this rate of growth in mind, HP recently announced some new innovations in its storage products portfolio. The innovations are in the HP 3PAR StoreServ Storage family, and include 25 per cent lower cost Flash capacity, a new class of massively scalable Flash arrays, and Flash-optimised data services to accelerate IT-as-a-Service consolidation and hybrid IT initiatives. HP has also introduced Flash-optimised software for end-to-end availability and non-disruptive workload balancing across the data centre. These capabilities are built on a strong set of Tier-1 data services.

With this launch, HP has re-established its faith in Flash storage. On the sidelines of the launch event, **Diksha P. Gupta** from **Open Source For You** caught up with **Barun Lala, director, storage, HP India**, to discuss the ever-evolving storage industry. So, if you are an IT head looking to understand the current storage market paradigm, read on...

Q What are the advantages that a customer gets with Flash storage?

The first and the most important advantage of Flash storage is the scalability that a customer gets. So, for example, in case there is a bomb blast in a certain city, people would want to read about it immediately on their mobile devices. During this period, if a website www.xyz.com gets huge traffic but is unable to scale itself in time, the next time, users will switch to another website. With Flash storage, scalability at any point of time (to a great extent) is not an issue.

The end customer experience is wonderful with Flash storage. For instance, if you are making a transaction from your mobile phone, you will not have the patience to hang on to it for too long. Rather, you would want to get over it in a flash. If you compare two different banks that have the same application, where one of them runs on a Flash based platform and takes three seconds to complete a transaction, while the other one, which doesn't have Flash architecture takes 12 seconds, do you think you will ever choose to transact with the latter? So it could be the end of the road for the